ETHNICS- LATINOS

Tape 9B - George 1-28-76

Informant-Archuga

pp. 8-9

narrative- personal narrative- teenagers lie to parents:
see car shaking and ghost of dead bride

nada. Pero ese hombre se enfermó...del susto. Cuando el llegó los tuvieron que que poner en el hospital muy enfermo. Y estoy...a--Yo no conozco al señor ese, pero platican las gentes que ese hombre todavía vive en Harbor. Pero pues, ¿Quien sera? No sé. Que era un bus driver. Era mexicano.

Entonces hay otro tambien que platican, pero no.--Ellos no dicen que la hayan visto. De este si le he platicado yo. Que habian ido unas muchachas--se iban a la--a las...a las movies en Saturday night. You know how all the teen-agers get together and--but--A lot of Mexican people don't let girls go with boys. They want girls go alone and boys go alone and that's hard to do you know. So the girls...lied to the parents, you know, and got together with the boy friends and went to the movies. And what the girls used to do was--They used to walk about one block or a little bit farther and meet the kids there and then to to the movies. On the way back the boys just leave them out of the car about a block away and they walk like they were coming alone. And the parents didn't mind, you know, for them walking around. At that time it was alright, you know, for everybody. Not like know. You cannot go out. (laughter) Well, anyways, a... they said when they were coming back, one of the girls was feeling real guilty, you know, by lieing to the parents. She kept on saying, "Boy, we shouldn't lie to our parents," you know, because it's not right, and everything. "Oh, shuddup! we went already. So what?" So they was standing there and all of a sudden this breezes start coming in. I mean, it was no breeze. All of a sudden there was this wind and it was...it was shaking the car completely. And one of the girls said, "You know what?" I look around, none of the trees were moving farther from us; just where we were standing. They said they was terrified. (Laughter) Ai!! My skin crawls. (Laughter and rubs hands over forearms) Because, you know, she said it, you know. "Something's here," she says, "I swear to God." And it's a very religious person, the one that told me that. She says, "I swear to God that that happened to us. We were sitting in the car. The car was shaking

and it looked like it was goint to blow away. And all the trees, every little bush, nothing was moving." But them--That car was shaking like crazy. So it passed, you know and the girls said, "See we're not going with our boy friends no more. We lied to our parents and that's it." They believe that's because they lied to their parents. And...probably a good explanation for it could be a, you know...Whata you call it? A...que le dice uno? Una-- Como le dicen a eso? Remolino. A remolino. Uh huh.(affirmative) Could be. Porque a veces...porque a veces yo los mire. Yo los mire en Texas pero esos eran no mas en tiempo de calor. Bueno, yo no recuerdo haber los visto en tiempo de frio. De repente baja y comienza a hacer mucho aire. Levanta...levanta papeles y todo in only one part. That could be, you know, it could be one explanation. But it could be many explanations. And the girls keep on saying it--They keep on saying it was la llorona. That it was trying to get revenge because they were near to the river. They, you know, like I told you, Cudahy is just one block away.

P. So she was punishing the girls for lieing to their parents?

Au. For lieing to their parents. That's what they believed. (NOISES) Oh, it's my husband and some other men. They bring a television. They're talking on the proch.

P. With the girl on Cline Ave. Era la llorona o...otra persona?

Au. Mucha gente a---Let me clear this up. Because no creyemos nosotros--No creen ellos que se haya sido la llorona. Ellos dicen que hubo una muchacha que se iba a casar and somebody killed her. La mataron on the day of her wedding. And on every eve of her wedding day she appears.

(Personal comments aside, in Spanish, to her husband, Alfonso.)

So that the people think that it is not the llorona. That it is that girl that was killed in her wedding night.

P. She was on her way to her wedding?